

RAS Biosecurity and Disease Response Protocol

Bayshore Sustainable Aquaculture | Reviewed with consulting veterinarian | Rev. 3

This protocol governs entry, sanitation, and the response sequence for a suspected health event in the shrimp recirculating system. It is the standing reference for the owner, the farm hand, and any visitor. The consulting veterinarian is the first call on any disease or biosecurity event.

Routine biosecurity

- Footbath at the hall entry charged daily; dedicated boots inside the grow-out hall.
- Nets, scoops, and gear are tank-specific and color-coded; no shared equipment between systems without disinfection.
- New post-larvae quarantined in the nursery and screened before transfer to grow-out.
- No outside seawater or wild stock enters the RAS loop.

Watch signs

- Sudden feed refusal, lethargy, or animals at the surface or edges.
- Discoloration, soft shell, white or cloudy muscle, fouled gills.
- Spike in morning mortality count above the baseline.

Response sequence

- 1 Isolate: stop transfers in or out of the affected tank; close shared returns if possible.
- 2 Sample and document: photograph, record water-quality readings, bag fresh-dead animals chilled for the vet.
- 3 Call the consulting veterinarian; do not medicate without guidance.
- 4 Tighten sanitation across all tanks; dedicate gear to the affected tank only.
- 5 Log the event, the timeline, and the corrective action in the health record.

Recovery and review

Hold the affected tank under daily observation until two clean counts. After any event, review the cause, update this protocol if needed, and confirm the maintenance card that covers the failure point (diffusers, biofilter, intake screens).

Husbandry protocol. Escalate disease or biosecurity events to the consulting veterinarian first.